ATTACK OF THE MUTANTS

Official Miniatures Edition Rules • Middle State Technical University Defense Compendium

> **Situation Briefing:** Two hours ago, Dr. Julian Manbender detonated his mutagenic weapon during a free "Green Energy" rock concert on the MSTU campus. A first wave of ravenous student mutants was repelled from the Science Building, but a massive second horde has surrounded the department. The defenders must hold the Ad Astra Lab, fire up the space-time rift, and eliminate Manbender in the past before the mutation cascade becomes permanent.

1. GENERAL OVERVIEW & VICTORY CONDITIONS

Attack of the Mutants (Miniatures Edition) is an asymmetric siege game played over 10 rounds (or 11 depending on portal calibration) between the Mutant Horde and the besieged Human Defenders.

- **Mutant Immediate Victory:** If at any point the mutants obtain sole possession of the **Ad Astra Lab** with no living humans inside, they immediately trash the equipment and win the game.
- **Human Victory:** If the humans hold the Ad Astra Lab at the end of **Turn 10** (or at the end of **Turn 9** if Dr. Mincey has occupied the lab continuously from Turn 6 through Turn 9), all surviving humans and robots inside the lab step through the portal into Dr. Manbender's lab for the **Final Confrontation**. Eliminating Manbender breaks the loop and wins the game!

2. INITIAL GAME SETUP

Map & Components

Place the Science Building map in the center of the table. Smashed door counters, casualty markers, and 12 barricades are kept nearby. Mutants begin in the designated exterior staging areas outside the building; humans and robots start inside.

Human Initial Setup

- **Professor Lab Confinement:** The three professors (Applewhite, Richardson, Mincey) must start in 3 separate facilities chosen from: *Quantum Engineering Lab, Robotics Lab, Ad Astra Lab,* and *High Performance Computing Center*.
- **Lockdown Period:** All three professors must remain in their starting labs for **Turns 1, 2, and 3**. At the start of Turn 4, they may move normally.
- **Tech Upgrade Roll:** At the start of Turn 4, roll 1D6 for each lab occupied by a professor. On a roll of **5 or 6**, that facility produces an experimental upgrade.
- **Teaching Assistants (TAs):** Penny Applewhite, Leon "Buck" Bukaw, and Percy Fitzwater may deploy in any room or corridor inside the building.
- **Robots:** GripBots and GunBots must start in an area with a human, with one exception: **GunBots™ may be deployed alone in hallways** to establish choke points.
- **Barricade Placement:** Humans place 12 physical barricades across doorways or corridors. Following the walls from one barricade, it can only be adjacent to *at most one* other barricade (the next opening must be an unbarricaded door). Hallway barricades count as both a wall and a barricade. Humans cannot pass through or smash barricades.

Mutant Initial Setup

Mutants deploy into the designated exterior staging areas surrounding the perimeter. Each area holds a maximum of **two mutants**. Any remaining mutants wait in the exterior reserve pool and enter during subsequent turn phases.

3. SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Each turn follows five distinct phases executed in sequential order:

Phase 1: Event & Initiative

1. **Mutant Reinforcements:** The Mutant player places additional figures into unoccupied exterior staging areas (up to 2 mutants per zone).
2. **Event Card Draw:** Draw the top card from the Event Deck. The effect lasts **only for the current turn** and only takes effect if the named character is currently in play.
3. **Penny's Affection:** Penny Applewhite chooses her favorite for the turn:
   - **Buck chosen:** Buck gains **+1 Combat Value (CV)**.
   - **Percy chosen:** Percy gains **+1 Robot Repair**.

Phase 2: Mutant Horde Action

1. **Glow-and-Go Check:** Roll 1D6 for each Red "Extra Glowing" Mutant on the board. On a roll of **1**, the mutant explodes and is removed from play. Any door or barricade smash test in that area later this phase gains a **+1 die roll bonus**.
2. **Smash! Tests:** Mutants attempt to smash closed doors or barricades according to the Smash! Matrix. *Glitch Exception:* If mutants occupy both sides of a door, sensor malfunction opens the door freely without a roll.
3. **Horde Movement:** Mutants move 1 area inward or shift between adjacent exterior staging zones.
4. **Contested Areas:** Mark every area containing both mutants and humans/bots for combat.

Phase 3: Human Movement & Field Repair

1. **Standard Movement:** Humans move 1 area. Interior automated doors open freely for humans. Humans cannot cross or smash barricades.
2. **Buck's Blitz:** A group moving with Leon "Buck" Bukaw may move up to **2 areas**, provided the first area entered is clear of mutants. Buck may lead figures starting with him or picked up on his first move.
3. **Field Repairs:** Humans and GripBots with Robot Repair skills test against their target numbers to restore damaged bots in their area.

Phase 4: Tactical Combat Resolution

The Mutant player selects the order of combat resolution. Combats last a maximum of **two rounds**. Up to 3 combatants per side form the front line; reserves wait off the line.

Phase 5: Victory Check

Verify Ad Astra Lab status. Advance the turn counter.

4. BREACHING DOORS & BARRICADES

To advance through locked sectors, mutants must batter down access points during Phase 2 or immediately following a combat victory.

Number of Mutants	Door Smash Roll	Barricade Smash Roll
1 Mutant	6	*Not Possible*
2 Mutants	5+	6
3 Mutants	4+	5+
4 or more Mutants	2+	4+

Modifier: Add +1 to the die roll if a Red Mutant exploded in that room during Glow-and-Go.

5. TACTICAL COMBAT MECHANICS

The Combat Resolution Pad

Miniatures engaged in a contested room are moved to the Combat Pad to enforce unit frontages and clarify reserve deployments.

```
  +-------------------------------------------------------------+ | ATTACKERS RESERVE | |
(Mutant reinforcements entering line) | +-----------------------------+-----------------
------------+ | ATTACKERS LINE (1-3) | DEFENDERS LINE (1-3) | | [ Slot 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] |
[ Slot 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] | +-----------------------------+-----------------------------+ |
DEFENDERS RESERVE | | (Human / Robot reserves entering line) | +------------------------
 ----------------------------------+ | WOUNDED BOX | | (Casualties awaiting extraction
    during retreat) | +-------------------------------------------------------------+
```

Line Deployment & Outnumbering

- Each line holds between **1 and 3 figures**. Remaining units wait in Reserve.
- **Outnumbering Bonus:** If one side has more figures on the active line than the opponent (excluding reserves), that side gains **+1 Combat Value (CV)**.
- **GunBot Negation:** If a GunBot™ is present on the human front line, mutants **never** receive the outnumbering bonus.

Combat Resolution Procedure

1. **Pairing:** The Mutant player pairs attacking mutants against defenders on the line.
2. **Dice Checks:** Each combatant rolls 1D6 and adds their Combat Value (CV) plus modifiers.
   Dice Notation: A CV written as 3x2 means roll two D6, take the highest die, and add 3.
3. **Highest Score Wins:** The loser is either removed (if mutant) or shifted to the Wounded Box (if human or robot). Attackers win ties (GunBot Wall of Lead is treated as an attacker for tie resolution).
4. **Wounded Extraction & Retreats:** Between rounds or following Round 2, each unwounded human or GripBot in reserve or an adjacent safe room may pull **one** casualty from the Wounded Box into safety. Excess unrescued wounded are eliminated.

5. **Combat Conclusion:** If both sides survive two rounds, calculate total casualties inflicted. The side that caused fewer casualties must retreat. If equal, defenders retreat. Victorious humans may **Press Forward** 1 area; victorious mutants gain a free **Smash! action**.

6. CHARACTER & MINIATURE PROFILES

Human Faculty & Teaching Assistants

Character	CV	Repair	Special Ability & Tactical Rules
Prof. Applewhite	2x2	6+	Delegates manual labor; weak field repair skills.
Prof. Richardson	3	5+	**Bot Coordinator:** GunBots everywhere gain +1 CV while she occupies the Robotics Lab.
Dr. Rosemarie Mincey	3	—	**Ad Astra Harmonics:** Holding the lab Turns 6–9 triggers the portal at Turn 9.
Penny Applewhite	4	—	**Affection:** Grants Buck +1 CV or Percy +1 Repair. *Messy Triangle:* -1 Def CV if with Buck & Percy.
Leon "Buck" Bukaw	6	5+	**Lead the Charge:** Moves 2 areas if first is clear; leads companions along.
Percy Fitzwater	3	4+ (x2)	**Master Tech:** May test repair on two robots or twice on one robot per turn.
GripBot™	4	5+	Can drag wounded in retreat. If wounded and alone, auto-drives to Robotics Lab via safest route.
GunBot™	3x2	—	**Armored:** CV 4 on defense. **Wall of Lead:** Rolls 3x6 when lone defender; denies mutant outnumbering.

The Mutant Menace

Unit Type	Total Count	CV	Tactical Abilities
Standard Mutant (Green)	56 miniatures	3	Shambling student horde; pushes front lines.
Radioactive Mutant (Red)	40 miniatures	3x2	**Glow-and-Go:** Detonates on 1 in Phase 2; grants +1 to local smash checks.
Campus Security Mutant	5 miniatures	5	Elite security force guarding Manbender's personal facility.
Dr. Julian Manbender	1 miniature	4	**Hive Controller:** Mutants sharing his room gain +1 CV on defense.

7. THE 10-TURN EVENT CARD DECK

Draw 1 card per round during Phase 1. Rules apply only for the current turn and require the associated figure to remain in play.

Character Key	Card Title	Game Effect
Prof. Applewhite	*"Maybe they can be reasoned with!"*	Mutants gain +1 CV in the first combat this turn.
Prof. Applewhite	*"Save your ammo, bullets can't hurt them!"*	Humans suffer -1 CV in the first combat this turn.
Prof. Applewhite	*"Robots should not have military use."*	GripBots™ may drag up to 2 wounded units during retreats this turn.
Prof. Applewhite	*"If my calculations are right…"*	GripBots™ gain +1 CV this turn.
Prof. Applewhite	*"Grant money will flow if we survive!"*	Fight 1 additional combat round in the first engagement this turn.
Prof. Richardson	*"Here's your education…"*	All robots gain +1 CV in their next fight this turn.
Prof. Richardson	*"Dance, Mutant, Dance!"*	GunBots™ roll 3x3 CV in their next fight this turn.
Prof. Richardson	*"This is no longer an abstract experiment"*	All robots may move up to 2 areas this turn.
Prof. Richardson	*"In the movies they say, Light them up!"*	Immediately eliminate 1 Green or Red Mutant from the board.
Prof. Richardson	*"Most of these mutants failed my class"*	Professor Richardson fights with CV: 3x2 this turn.
Prof. Richardson	*"GripBots have a good throwing arm"*	GripBots™ fight with CV: 4x2 this turn.
Dr. Mincey	*"Woodstock Reset Time to Zero!"*	Humans ignore morale and retreat penalties this turn.
Dr. Mincey	*"The Age of Aquarius is Upon us!"*	Mutants cannot claim outnumbering bonuses this turn.
Dr. Mincey	*"Not to be bound by the rules…"*	Instantly reposition Dr. Mincey to any area inside the building.
Dr. Mincey	*"…but to create one's own rules"*	Dr. Mincey's Combat Value increases to 5 this turn.
Dr. Mincey	*"Let's test this frequency on the mutants"*	Mutant player must immediately remove 1D6 mutants from play.
Leon "Buck" Bukaw	*"Intellectual Diversity Pledge"*	Buck fights with CV: 5x2 this turn.
Leon "Buck" Bukaw	*"College Founding Fathers Creed"*	Humans gain +1 CV in any combat involving Buck this turn.
Leon "Buck" Bukaw	*"About that 2nd Amendment"*	GunBots™ gain +1 CV this turn.
Leon "Buck" Bukaw	*"Die you Hippy Mutant"*	Remove 1 mutant from the reserve line in Buck's next fight.
Percy Fitzwater	*"Artificial Intelligence, Real Stupidity"*	Robot logic failure; all robots suffer -1 CV this turn.
Percy Fitzwater	*"Zombie Attack Nerd Rage"*	Percy fights with CV: 3x2 this turn.

Character Key	Card Title	Game Effect
Percy Fitzwater	*"My elongated Oblongata is very sexy"*	1 wounded robot is automatically repaired at the end of the turn.
Percy Fitzwater	*"I turn coffee into theorems"*	All wounded robots on the board are instantly repaired.
Percy Fitzwater	*"Logic and Set Theory"*	All mutants suffer -1 CV to defense in the next fight.
Percy Fitzwater	*"Increase the gain on the controllers now!"*	Instantly reposition 1 robot to any area on the board.

8. ENDGAME: THE AD ASTRA RIFT & FINAL SHOWDOWN

The campaign culminates in a time-travel assault to eliminate Julian Manbender in his past laboratory before the concert weapon is detonated:

- **Early Activation (Turn 10 Showdown):** If Dr. Rosemarie Mincey holds the Ad Astra Lab continuously from **Turn 6 through Turn 9**, the rift opens early at the end of Turn 10.
- **Standard Activation (Turn 11 Showdown):** If Dr. Mincey was displaced or absent, holding the lab through Turn 10 powers the machine for a Turn 11 climax.

Final Showdown Tactical Modifications

1. **Strike Force:** All living humans and functional robots inside the Ad Astra Lab step through the rift into Manbender's private research facility.
2. **Defending Force:** Dr. Julian Manbender (CV: 4) and his 5 elite Mutated Campus Police officers (CV: 5 each).
3. **Surprise Strike:** Materializing from thin air catches the mutants off guard: all mutant defenders suffer **-1 CV to defense during Round 1**.
4. **No Round Limit:** Combat continues beyond the standard two-round cap until one side is wiped out.
5. **No Extraction / No Retreat:** No casualties may be dragged into safety; there are no adjacent rooms to retreat to.
6. **Climactic Victory:** Killing Dr. Julian Manbender wins the game for Humanity and restores the timeline. If the assault party is wiped out while Manbender lives, the Mutants claim total victory.